

Hrishikesh Pawar

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Education

Worcester Polytechnic Institute

August 2023 - May 2025

Master of Science in Robotics Engineering; GPA: 4.0/4.0

Worcester, MA

Courses: CS541-Deep Learning, RBE549-Computer Vision, RBE595-Vision based Robot Manipulation, REB550-Motion Planning

Teaching Assistant: RBE595-Vision based Robot Manipulation, RBEBL01-Robots for Recycling

Experience

PeAR Lab | Graduate Researcher advised by [Prof. Nitin Sanket](#) | Worcester, MA

August 2024 – Present

- Developed a Depth-from-Defocus framework with event cameras for computationally efficient autonomous navigation.
- Implementing RL policy for adaptive control of optical parameters, improving navigation efficiency and obstacle avoidance.
- Developed a custom **3D Gaussian Splats** simulator for **high frame-rate**, realistic frames and events, enabling **HITL** testing.

Nobi | AI Software Intern | Remote

May 2024 - August 2024

- Led R&D efforts for smart ceiling lamps improving real-time fall detection and emergency response in elderly care.
- Engineered a **rotation-aware** detection model by integrating **Swin Transformers**, improving accuracy from **85 mAP** to **92 mAP**.
- Experimented with **LLaVa** and **CLIP**, applying **LoRA** for **PEFT** fine-tuning for vision-language detection task generalization.
- Reduced deployment time by **30%**, automating end-to-end deployment pipeline using **Jenkins**, **Kubernetes** and **Docker**.

Adagrad AI | Computer Vision Engineer | Pune, India

November 2020 - July 2023

- Worked on R&D for **Gate-Guard**, an edge-based Boom Barrier system using **Automatic License Plate Recognition (ALPR)**.
- Achieved accuracy of **97%** for four-wheelers and **95%** for two-wheelers with **50 fps** throughput on **Nvidia Jetson-TX2**.
- Designed interactive analytics and monitoring services using **Django**, **Azure**, **WebSockets**, **Kafka**, **Celery** and **Redis**.
- Featured links: [Indian Express](#) | [Times of India](#) | [YouTube](#)

Publications

Hrishikesh Pawar*, Deepak Singh*, Nitin J. Sanket, "**Blurring for Clarity: Passive Computation for Defocus-Driven Parsimonious Navigation using a Monocular Event Camera**," Accepted for presentation at **EVGEN Workshop, IEEE WACV 2025**.

- Introduced a biologically inspired approach leveraging optical defocus in **event cameras** for **parsimonious** aerial navigation.
- Applied optical defocus to extract **sharpness-based depth cues**, segmenting foreground obstacles from the background.
- Achieved **70%** success rate with **62x** computational savings compared to state-of-the-art methods.

Projects

Deep Visual-Inertial Odometry | [GitHub](#) | [Project Report](#)

- Developed a VIO stack, coupling **CNNs** for image processing and **LSTMs** for sequential inertial data enhancing pose estimation.
- Generated synthetic datasets in **Blender** simulating trajectories with realistic sensor noise to improve model robustness.
- Trained Visual-Inertial models combining **MSE** and **Geodesic Loss** reducing the RMSE **Absolute Trajectory Error** by **28%**.
- Won the **best project** award for the **Computer Vision course (RBE-549)** at **WPI** amongst **40** graduate students.

Zero-Shot Semantic Neural Style Transfer for Images | [GitHub](#)

- Implemented **AdaAttN** module enabling per-point attentive normalization for **zero-shot semantic neural style transfer**.
- Achieved a **13%** reduction in training time without loss of style transfer quality by removing deeper attention layers.
- Integrated **AdaAttN** with **CLIPSeg's** prompt-based segmentation, enabling user-defined, localized neural style transfer.

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, C, C++, SQL
- **Frameworks:** PyTorch, OpenCV, TensorFlow, ONNX, NumPy, Pandas, Django, Flask, Celery, Kafka, MATLAB, CMake, Docker, TensorRT, Jenkins, Kubernetes, Git, ROS, ROS2